

**Minutes – Cincinnati Contra Board Meeting –
February 2, 2025 7:00 pm**

Present: Steve Edwards, Cori Yaeger, Myra Mitchell, Valerie Allendorf, Bonnie Carpenter, Josh Telecsan, Michael Hentz, Charles Wallner, Larry Lankford, Philip Ogston, Deven Corzine, Audrey Eyman (left 8:14 pm) Kurt Grannan joined 7:42

Meeting started at 7:05

Introduction

Meeting Minutes from 01/05/25 approved by consensus.

Treasurer's Report - abbreviated report accepted by consensus. Larry needs someone to pay band and caller for February 8 dance. Philip volunteered.

Secretary's report - Cori - asked about the mold abatement going on at WFAC – we didn't find out until midday last Monday, so not enough time to let dancers know. Cori will let our local dancer-email list know. Say that WFAC's basement mold remediation will be done on February 6.

WFAC report – Pay \$125 per dance paying for missed dances – goodwill gesture. Steve has been in contact with the board member Zachary Johnson who is the facilities person and will get back with us on AC questions.

Myra reported that Brenda Grannan is willing to be CCD liaison for next year. (maybe sooner – maybe Brenda would be interested in becoming a board member?)

Speaker – Josh says need written permission from WFAC for Josh and Philip to check out the speaker – but need to have that permission. Steve will send Josh the contact for Zachary Johnson.

Social Secretary Report – cards to Larry Lankford, Richard House, Frankenhoffs, John McCain.

Scheduling Report – All ok.

Old Business

Pigtown – Valerie – coming along smoothly. Ahead of last year's registration (+64). Past breakeven point. Should be fine!

T-shirts from DIY – Aaron Kent – who is giving us the same 100 discount we gave us last year, though we will likely only be ordering around 75.

Buttons coming from a USA company with only magnets – no pins. 2 ½" (last year we did 2 ¼")

Techno Dance – workshop plus a dance.

Website – Cori working with Ben Schriber from Dam Beavers, who may be able to help us with finishing up the website. Cori will ask for his portfolio and references to other websites he's designed. Hours, scope of work.

New callers – Steve reported they are going great. Hope they are getting enough time to call if they want. All going well.

Google Drive progress – Josh will contact Cori about seeing what files each has and how to organize.

½ day retreat – Audrey working on some names for facilitator, choose a date. The committee needs to meet.

Recruiting more dancers – Michael Hentz suggested using a meet-up group. Can we make a contra dance meet-up group? Michael will investigate it and whether cost and how much?

Charles has current info on media contacts to look at promoting. Charles will send the list out.

Kurt mentioned that he has started a conversation with the dance club at Mt. St. Joseph. Valerie indicated that we are posted weekly on a regional dance site.

Bonnie asked about City Beat and other media. Need to write up a PSA. Audrey suggested looking at websites such as city beat, Cincinnati magazine, incity – things to do.

Michael asked if he can have photos etc to use on MeetUp.

Some discussion about using photos on website and other social media.

Philip suggested a sheet on the back table saying “if you don't want photos posted to social media or our website, email to this address to opt-out”

Philip mentioned that we are doing really well when compared to 6 months or a year ago – where now on Monday nights we now have two lines at least part of the time.

New Business

Mount Echo Park Advisory Council (MEPAC) in October – Mt Echo park, wants us to do a demonstration contra dance. 1 dance 12 dancers, one caller, recorded music. Philip will let Eleanor know we are interested and verify dates.

River Roots in October – also a chance to showcase contra? Audrey and Bonnie working on it.

Callers and bands – policies. Steve and Charles worked on a policy for hiring bands. Currently 11 bands and 9 callers. See document below* - maybe having out of town bands on alternate Saturday dances. Need to solicit feedback from bands. Bonnie and Steve will work on this. Philip suggested that all bands/callers who want to come and perform for us, that they contact only the scheduler.

Myra suggested that she'd like to see our board less rigid and more flexible. Philip indicated that maybe we do need to be rigid only about money!

Board member roles and responsibilities - tabled

Alternate venue – Valerie

Alternative Venue

Four sites were suggested: Tango Delbario, Everybody's Dance Hall, Peter and Paul Catholic Church, Evendale Center.

Purpose could be for Several Night Backup to WFAC, Demo Nights to attract new people in different area, or Replacement to WFAC. General Info about space, availability, cost, sound and location to be collected to have on hand.

Meeting was adjourned at 8:55

Next month – advertising for new dancers – PSAs and local publications.

Next meeting: March 2, 2025, 7:00 pm zoom

*HIRING OF BANDS

POLICY AND PROCEDURES

BACKGROUND - For the first 6 months of 2025, we have 11 “local” bands with a variety of energetic styles. Four of the bands will play for 3 Mondays and 1 Saturday each. Seven of the bands will play for 2 Mondays each. We have two “regional” bands playing for one Saturday each. For the first half of 2025 we have 9 callers. Four callers (Frank, Darlene, Beth, Margaret) calling 4-5 times each. Four callers (Steve, Kenny, Dan, Bob) calling 3 times each. Nick calling one time.

POLICY

The board strives to provide affordable, quality dancing experiences while supporting our local and regional musicians and callers.

Goals TO BE MET BY POLICY

- Local bands have enough playing times to meet their needs.
- We have a sufficient number of bands to avoid burnout from too many sessions.
- Local bands understand the dance finances and feel appreciated with the monetary payments

Procedures

- Regional bands may be used to add variety as needed and CCD will support additional artists
- Regional bands may be compensated for travel cost on a case by case basis (Cori: need to have board prior approval.)
- Local and Regional Bands will receive equal compensation for playing times.

- Tip Jars will be used to allow moderate general admission prices and have dancers provide additional support as they are able

-Given the number of quality local bands at this time, CCD sees little need to increase compensation to bring in “Big Name” bands for weekly and monthly dances.

- Bands requesting gigs as they travel will be advised that we do scheduling twice a year. Bands requesting weekends other than the 2nd Saturday will be referred to the applicable dance community.

Adopted

Date

Update on WFAC – WFAC is doing mold remediation in the basement which will be finished on February 6. They have asked us not to use the basement bathrooms until after Feb 6.